Day 17 — Quick Revision Notes

Excel Data Analysis | Pivot Charts • Chart Selection • KPI Visualization • Management Reporting

1. Pivot Charts

- Purpose: Visualize summarized data from PivotTables.
- Filters/Slicers: Focus on selected countries or categories without deleting source data.
- Clear filters: Restore the full view.

Remember:

- Country comparison → Column/Bar Chart
- Monthly trend → Line Chart

2. Chart Selection

Business question	Best chart
Compare countries	Bar / Column
Show monthly trends	Line
Show proportions of a whole	Pie (few categories)
Explore relationship between two numerical variables	Scatter

Rule: Choose the chart according to the business question.

3. KPI Visualization

A KPI measures progress toward a business objective.

Important formulas

- Variance = Actual − Target
- Achievement % = Actual ÷ Target × 100
- Shortfall = Target − Actual
- Growth % = (Current − Previous) ÷ Previous × 100
- Overall Achievement % = Total Actual ÷ Total Target × 100

Day 17 example

Country	Target	Actual	Achievement
India	15,000	16,500	110%
Kenya	12,000	10,800	90%
Nigeria	10,000	8,000	80%
Total	37,000	35,300	95.41%

- Overall variance = −1,700 bookings
- India exceeded target.
- Kenya and Nigeria missed target.
- Nigeria has the lowest achievement.

Important: Calculate overall achievement using total actual ÷ total target. Do not simply average country percentages when targets differ.

4. Management Reporting

A good management report answers three questions:

1. What happened? — Actual results and KPIs.
2. Why does it matter? — Performance gaps and exceptions.
3. What should happen next? — Evidence-based recommendations.

How to investigate a performance gap

If Nigeria is at 80% achievement:

1. Investigate branch-level performance.
2. Check product/service performance.
3. Analyze salesperson performance.
4. Review monthly or weekly trends.
5. Identify the cause before recommending action.

Never blame a team without evidence.

5. Dashboard Best Practices

- Show important KPI cards first.
- Compare actual versus target.
- Use clear charts and labels.
- Highlight exceptions.
- Keep the layout simple.
- Include concise findings and recommendations.
- Avoid unnecessary charts and unsupported conclusions.

6. Remember This Analyst Workflow

Data → KPI → Chart → Insight → Investigation → Action

A chart shows what happened. Analysis helps explain why. Evidence supports what to do next.

Final 5-point self-test

1. Monthly trend? Line chart.
2. Achievement formula? Actual ÷ Target × 100.
3. Overall achievement? Total Actual ÷ Total Target × 100.
4. Lowest achievement in our example? Nigeria — 80%.
5. What comes after identifying a performance gap? Investigate the cause before recommending corrective action.

Day 17 complete! Focus your revision on chart selection, KPI formulas, and turning findings into business recommendations.